

bitcoin's markets has been moderating over time. We include this dive into bitcoin's speculative past to help inform future investigation of cryptoassets as they come to market and inevitably get swept up in periods of mass speculation.

Bitcoin Bubbles

When Mt. Gox was established, bitcoin finally became accessible to the mainstream. Prior to this point, bitcoin holders had mostly been computer and cryptography wizzes, acquiring bitcoin as a function of running the computers that supported the network. [Figure 10.1](#) shows the price action of bitcoin on a log scale since the start of Mt. Gox. Recall that charts with log scales are good at showing the percent price appreciation of an asset over time. On a linear scale, the early years of bitcoin's price appreciation would be less evident.

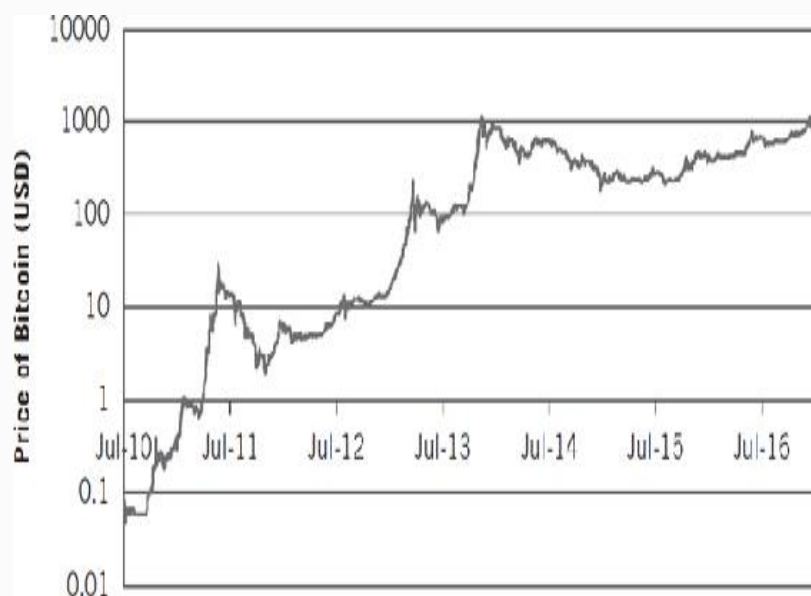


Figure 10.1 ■ Bitcoin's price action from Mt. Gox until early 2017
Data sourced from CoinDesk